

Hearth Companion

An agent in the room that acts within limits, asks above them, and asks *her* before it alarms anyone.

AI agents are about to start acting — and spending — for people. So we built one for the person who needs a guardrail most: an older adult living alone, who can't use a phone.

Hearth lives in her room — a laptop's camera, mic and speaker. She talks; it sees her, runs her errands, and pays — but only within a weekly limit her family set. Above it, it stops: her daughter gets a tap-to-approve on Telegram. One tap, one charge, never twice.

And if she falls, the camera doesn't panic anyone. Hearth asks her first: "*Marie, are you okay?*" Only silence, or a call for help, reaches her daughter — with a photo, in seconds.

THREE THINGS IT DOES

Money, with a leash

"Order my groceries for the week." Basket €84 > limit €60
→ Claire approves on Telegram
→ one Stripe charge → Hearth tells Marie when it arrives.

It sees her

"Do I have my glasses on?"
Answers from the live camera frame. Only talks about the room when asked.

Falls: ask first

Two confirmations (~4 s) → heads-up to Claire → Hearth asks her → "I'm fine" closes it; silence or "help" → photo alert + "I'm on it".

RULES IN CODE, NOT IN THE PROMPT

- The vulnerable person is never the sole approver of a large spend.
- One approval, one charge — consumed in a single atomic database statement; a second tap charges nothing.
- The camera never alarms directly; emergency services are never called automatically — a human decides.

Act within limits · Ask above them · Bring a human in only when it matters.

LINKS

Live <https://hearth-companion-cyan.vercel.app>

Code <https://github.com/Loudiyii/hearth-companion>

Stack OpenAI GPT-Live + gpt-5.6-luna · Supabase · Vercel · Telegram · Stripe (test) · Trigger.dev · CopilotKit

Built at AI Tinkerers "Agents, Everywhere" — Paris, 12 Sept 2026

Stripe is test mode against a simulated shop. Falls are the case; bounded agency is the idea.